

discussion we have in here. But no matter what we all love to have a bulk of music and movies resting in our hard drives. Ubuntu comes pre-installed with media player for both music and video. We have for you Banshee which plays music for you. But as we told, Ubuntu does not support MP3s. Hold on; make your heart thump a little longer. Give us just one second to bring you back to life. Let us tell you that although Ubuntu does not play MP3 files by 'default', it can be hypnotized to do so. The best thing about Banshee is that when you start it and make it play, its first MP3 file, it would tell you that it did not find the proper codecs for playing the file and will offer you to download the codecs right away. What else do you need? Just confirm and Ubuntu would be more than happy to get you the free codecs from the Internet, install it and make you feel relaxed.

The reason Ubuntu does not play MP3 and any other restricted format by default lies in its freedom concept. Since you buy Windows or a Mac, they come preinstalled with the codecs required to play MP3 files. Microsoft and Apple would have paid for the license required to play MP3 files. Ubuntu on the other hand is given away for free. It is this reason that it cannot afford to provide those codecs which require investment on its part. The other part of the problem is the dislike most open source developers have for the restricted content including restricted codecs which are required to play MP3 files. The ones which Ubuntu downloads are developed by the community and are made available for free. This is the reason why you have to download them separately. The same is the case with other video formats. If you have (and chances are that you do), videos in AVI or WMV formats, Ubuntu would not be able to play them but would once again offer you free codecs when it first encounters a restricted video format.

Music

Ubuntu comes as we already said preinstalled with Banshee. It is the music player for Ubuntu. The best things about it are the ease of use and the integration of services that it offers. You can launch Banshee from the Unity top panel by clicking on the sound icon. Banshee also integrates with the online music stores like Amazon MP3 Store, Miro Guide, Last.fm and finally the Ubuntu One Music store. The interface of Banshee is something between that of iTunes and Windows Media Player. It has a sidebar and the right hand bar which has playlists and cover arts listen on its face. You can select the playlist or music source from the left and listen to it.